conduct con · duct

Definition

noun

1. the way a person acts; behavior.

   People expect good conduct from leaders in government.

verb

1. to lead or guide.

   She conducted a tour of the museum.
   He conducted the orchestra.

2. to carry electricity through or along something.

   Copper conducts well.
   Plastic does not conduct electricity.

Advanced Definition

noun

1. the way one acts; behavior.

   He was let out of prison for good conduct.
   The defendant's conduct during the grueling trial was admirable.

2. guidance or course.

   The article gives a detailed account of the administration's conduct of the war.

transitive verb

1. to comport or keep control of (oneself).

   Utterly bored, the children nonetheless conducted themselves well.
   She was nervous, but she conducted herself very professionally at the interview.

2. to manage and direct.

   Some of the staff are critical of the way the boss is conducting the business.
   He conducts his affairs in a tightly organized manner.

3. to guide and lead.

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Every summer, she conducts tours to Italy.

4. to do or carry out.

   The police are conducting an investigation into the man's death.
   The woman on the phone was conducting a survey.

5. to direct (a musical group or the playing of a piece of music).

   She conducted the orchestra in its summer concerts this year.
   This is the first time that he will be conducting Beethoven's ninth symphony.

6. to allow passage through or along, as of heat or electricity.

   Those wires conduct electricity to the building.

intransitive verb

1. to lead.
2. to direct the performance of music.

   Do you know who will be conducting in tonight's performance?

Spanish cognate

conducta: The Spanish word *conducta* means conduct.

These are some examples of how the word or forms of the word are used:

1. On February 2, NASA, the U.S. space agency, released its findings from Kepler's sky search conducted between May and September 2009.
2. Physician assistants (PAs) practice medicine under the supervision of doctors. Conducting physical exams, interpreting tests, and writing prescriptions are all part of the job.
3. Toyota subsequently conducted a study of unintended acceleration in its vehicles. It concluded that the problem may have been caused by "sticky pedals," possibly ones catching on floor mats.
4. "You can get within two meters of a beaver if you conduct yourself properly," Coco says. "Don't walk on your heels or your toes," he instructs, "keep your feet flat on the ground."
5. So, lawmakers began to create protective measures in favor of farmers. These are called "right to farm" laws, and they are now enacted in every state. Essentially, they are what they sound like: laws that protect a farmer's right to conduct his or her business.
6. Duke Ellington was a composer. This means he wrote music. He also played the piano and conducted bands.
7. "I think I have a new lesson for you, though," Dad said. "I want to show you how to conduct an experiment."
8. He became a professor at the Tuskegee Institute in Alabama. There, he was a leading expert in agriculture. He conducted lots of experiments.
9. The conductor stands with his or her back to the crowd and conducts all of the musicians. The conductor keeps rhythm with a stick.
10. So DeSean decided to conduct an experiment of his own. "Hey, I'm going to ask the kitchen staff if we can weigh each plate

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separately this time," he said. “Then we’ll know whose fault this is.”

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